

Dr Jade Quinton Maggs

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I am a fisheries scientist and data professional with 18 years of experience and a strong track record in collaborative research. Currently, I work in the Fisheries Monitoring team in Queensland's Department of Primary Industries. Previously, I worked in the Wild Fisheries Flagship Programme at Earth Sciences New Zealand (formerly NIWA), where I was the Group Manager for the Modelling & Recreational Fisheries team. I have specialised in recreational fisheries research, with a focus on harvest estimation for inshore finfish and rock lobster fisheries. In 2017, I earned a PhD in Fisheries Science from Rhodes University in South Africa. My expertise includes data management and GIS, and I have lectured part-time at postgraduate level on fishery stock assessment and R programming.

Professional Experience

DEPARTMENT OF PRIMARY INDUSTRIES (Brisbane)

Technical Officer

Dec 2025 – present

- Member of the Fisheries Monitoring Team
- Developing and maintaining Power Automate flows to deliver data collection summaries via Power BI dashboards
- Building automated data tracking workflows using Power Automate to query databases, update SharePoint lists, run data quality checks via Power BI paginated reports, distribute outlier reports
- Supporting data migration testing with Jira as part of a transition from on-premises MS SQL Server to cloud infrastructure (Azure, Microsoft Fabric)
- Contributing to boat ramp recreational fisheries data collection and lab-based fish sample processing

EARTH SCIENCES NEW ZEALAND (formerly NIWA)

Fisheries Scientist | Group Manager

Jan 2022 – Dec 2025

- Group Manager: Modelling and Recreational Fisheries (five staff)
- Project leader for national boat ramp creel surveys of the recreational fishery and other projects
- Fisheries modelling (GLM, CPUE standardisation, harvest estimation, recreational release mortality)
- Member of the Marine Amateur Fisheries and Inshore Fisheries Assessment working groups
- R, PostgreSQL, Linux, QGIS, GitLab
- Led implementation of electronic data acquisition and streamlined workflows
- Selected for in-house Leadership Development Programme
- Center for Independent Experts reviewer

Research Data Manager | Group Manager

Apr 2020 – Dec 2021

- Group Manager: Fisheries Data Services (six staff)
- Managed all fisheries data from research and observer programmes for NIWA and New Zealand's Ministry for Primary Industries
- Managed commercial rock lobster catch sampling project
- Led development of data loading software and PostgreSQL databases
- Delivered efficiencies and significant improvements across multiple workflows
- PostgreSQL, Bash, Linux, QGIS, GitLab

MINISTRY FOR PRIMARY INDUSTRIES (New Zealand)

Senior Analyst – Fisheries Management

Jan 2019 – Mar 2020

- Contributed to the development of ecosystem-based fisheries management approaches
- Member of the Marine Protected Area (MPA) Science Advisory Group
- Engaged with stakeholders on proposed MPA networks, including those affecting commercial rock lobster fisheries

OCEANOGRAPHIC RESEARCH INSTITUTE (South Africa)

Scientist, *Jun 2018 – Dec 2018*

Assistant Scientist, *Aug 2011 – May 2018*

Senior Scientific Technician, *Jul 2008 – Jul 2011*

Scientific Technician, *May 2006 – Jun 2008*

- Led recreational fisheries surveys (shore- and boat-based)
 - Fisheries modelling, including GLMs, CPUE standardisation, and fish movement analysis
 - Field surveys to monitor relative abundance, movement, and community composition of fishes
 - Delivered postgraduate lectures on fisheries stock assessment and R programming
 - Performed biological sampling of commercial fish species
 - Developed and administered fisheries monitoring databases using PostgreSQL
 - Member of the Linefish Scientific Working Group
 - Managed a team of three staff and a research aquarium laboratory
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Academic Qualifications

- PhD (Fisheries Science) | Rhodes University, 2017
 - Thesis title: Movement of coastal fishery species in southern Africa: research trends, characterisation of behaviours and a case study on fishery implications. Supervisor: Prof. Paul Cowley.
 - MSc (Biology) | University of KwaZulu-Natal, 2011
 - Thesis title: Fish surveys in exploited and protected areas of the Pondoland Marine Protected Area with consideration of the impact of the MPA on coastal fisheries. Supervisors: Dr Bruce Mann & Prof. Paul Cowley.
 - BSc (Zoology, specialising in environmental management) | University of South Africa, 2009
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Lecturing Experience

- Fishery stock assessment (University of KwaZulu-Natal, 2012-2018) - Postgraduate
 - Introduction to R Programming (2016, 2017) - Postgraduate
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Technical Skills

- **Software:** R | Power BI | Power Automate | GIT | QGIS | Linux | Bash | L^AT_EX
 - **Statistics:** Maximum likelihood | Generalised linear modelling
 - **Data management:** PostgreSQL | MS SQL Server | Azure | Microsoft Fabric | SharePoint | Jira
 - **Field:** Class IV Commercial Diver (563 hrs) | Class IV Commercial Dive Supervisor (313 hrs) | Commercial Boat Skipper | Level 2 First Aid | STCW – PST, PSSR
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Training

- Zonation decision support software training (NIWA, Sep 2019)
 - Ecofish stock assessment interpretation (Dept. of Agriculture, Forestry and Fisheries, Apr 2017)
 - Introduction to L^AT_EX (University of KwaZulu-Natal, Jun 2016)
 - Introduction to Fisheries Genetics (University of Stellenbosch, Mar 2016)
 - Species distribution modelling (University of Stellenbosch, Feb 2013)
 - Ecological modelling (IRD/University of Cape Town, Jun 2012)
 - Statistical modelling Using R (Tromsø University, Sep 2011)
 - Fish stock assessment (FAO/SWIOFP - Kenya, Sep-Oct 2010)
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Publications

Career summary: 24 peer-reviewed journal articles, 21 working group presentations, 1 book section, 2 theses, 2 conference proceedings, 81 reports, 22 conference presentations, 2 posters, 16 popular articles. See [ResearchGate](#).

Referees

Dr Jonathan Staunton-Smith | Senior Fisheries Biologist | DPI, Brisbane (current manager)

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Mr Jonathan Moores | Regional Manager | NIWA, Auckland

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